

[Feature Name]

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Version History

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Problem Statement

1.Problem

Da Nang is already operating at scale as a destination: in the first seven months of 2025 alone, the city welcomed **10.7 million visitors, including over 4.2 million international arrivals**, generating about **VND 33.8 trillion** in tourism-related revenue.[link](#) The city is

actively pushing smart tourism and the year-end stimulus programme “**New Da Nang – -New Experience**” to diversify products and apply digital solutions across the service chain.[link](#)

However, most “deep” experiences still cluster around a few familiar corridors (beachfront, Ba Na Hills, Hoi An), and current digital tools (portals, VR apps, chatbots) are largely informational or per-activity, not a continuous, city-level companion.[link](#) This makes a smart AI local buddy naturally **less relevant for fixed-itinerary package tour groups**, but highly valuable for **free independent travellers (FITs) and business visitors**, who want flexible, context-rich guidance on where to stay, work, eat and explore across different districts rather than just following a standard tour script.

2. Impact on the City (Public, Private, Governance)

From the public side, Da Nang’s tourism programmes explicitly aim to welcome about **17.3 million overnight visitors in 2025**, including **7.6 million international guests**, by diversifying experiences and spreading benefits beyond traditional hotspots.[data](#) Without a personalised, city-integrated AI companion for FITs and business travellers, it is hard to steer demand toward new areas, lengthen stays, or systematically support people who want to test Da Nang as a long-term base for work and life.

On the private side, smaller local businesses, cafés, co-working spaces and services outside the main tourist strips remain largely invisible, even though smart-tourism research notes that Da Nang has already built substantial ICT and data infrastructure and is treating smart tourism as a key pillar of its smart-city strategy.[quote](#)

From a governance perspective, a city-level AI local buddy gives authorities a new, **privacy-respecting data layer**: aggregated insights into *why* people come (short city break, MICE, scouting a place to live), *where* they want to go, and *what* they struggle

with. This kind of data, in line with broader smart-tourism and digital-governance practice, can help Da Nang:

- + Target public services and information more precisely,
 - + Identify overcrowding or low-quality services early, and
 - + Reduce the risk of negative phenomena (unbalanced development, unmanaged flows, poor visitor experiences) as volumes keep rising. [ResearchGate+1](#)
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3. Why Now

In June 2025, Viet Nam's National Assembly approved a resolution to establish **International Financial Centres (IFCs) in Ho Chi Minh City and Da Nang**, with the framework taking effect on **1 September 2025**.[link](#) The IFC is intended to attract international capital and skilled professionals and to reshape Viet Nam's financial role in the region—Da Nang's identity is therefore shifting from “only” a beach destination to a combined **tourism + business + lifestyle hub**. At the same time, the city is highlighted as a pioneer in digital tourism, rolling out a shared big-data system and AI-enabled services to connect authorities and businesses. [Thông tấn xã Việt Nam](#)

Globally, AI-powered travel assistants and hyper-personalised, data-driven tourism are becoming mainstream, but **city-branded, city-integrated AI “local buddies” tailored to FITs and business visitors are still rare**.[link](#) Launching a Da Nang-specific AI agent now would:

- + Give independent and business travellers a high-value companion that extends their experience beyond classic tour-group corridors,

- + Open up new areas and services across the city for both visitors and long-stay residents
- + Provide exactly the experiential and data foundation Da Nang needs to function not just as a resort city, but as a credible, well-governed **international financial centre**.

Objective

Build a Da Nang-specific AI local buddy that makes the city's smart-city and IFC vision tangible in everyday life, while spreading benefits more evenly across people and places.

1. **Make smart city feel real, not abstract**

Turn Da Nang's digital-government and smart-city initiatives into something residents and visitors can actually feel: clear guidance on where to go, what to do, which services to use, instead of "smart city" staying as a policy slogan.

2. **Support Da Nang as a work and finance hub, not just a beach stop**

Give independent travellers and people coming for work (experts, corporate staff, remote workers) a soft landing where culture, lifestyle and daily logistics are easy to understand, aligning with the national plan to build an International Financial Centre in Da Nang.

3. **Spread income and opportunity across the whole city**

Direct demand beyond a few classic tourist pockets into community-based, eco-tourism and emerging urban areas, so more households and small businesses can participate in tourism and service growth.

4. Reinforce Da Nang's identity as an international city

Increase meaningful contact between locals and a diverse mix of visitors and long-stay residents, building on Da Nang's positioning as a digital, innovative, globally connected city rather than only a seasonal holiday destination.

Key User Scenarios

1. Independent Traveler – Short City Break (3 days in Da Nang)

-Context

A solo traveler from Korea arrives in Da Nang for a 3-day trip. They speak basic English, almost no Vietnamese, and prefer to explore on their own rather than join a tour. They want to move around easily, avoid “tourist traps,” and understand basic local info (weather, traffic, opening hours).

-Ideal Journey

- + User scans a QR code at the airport and opens the **web-based AI buddy** (no download, just browser).
- + They see a single, simple interface: **chat box + voice button** with multi-language support.
- + User taps the voice button (in Korean or English): “I’m at the airport, I want to go to ‘123 Nguyễn Văn Thoại’. Can you help me book a ride?”
- + The AI recognizes the Vietnamese address, confirms the location on a map, and generates a **direct deep-link to Grab** so the user can book with one tap, without typing Vietnamese.
- + On the way, the user continues chatting: “What’s the weather like this afternoon? Is there any risk of heavy rain near the beach?” The AI returns a concise answer and suggests the best time window to go out.

- + In the evening, the user asks: “Is the road to Son Trà busy now? Any safer route for a motorbike?” The AI responds with up-to-date road guidance and a suggestion to avoid certain hours or areas.

-Benefit

The traveler never feels “stuck” because of language or local logistics. They can move around freely with just voice/chat and a browser, which directly supports Da Nang’s goal of making smart-city services visible and useful to everyday visitors.

2. Business Visitor – One Week Work Trip (IFC / Corporate Meetings)

-Context

A regional manager from a multinational company flies to Da Nang for a one-week work trip. They have a tight meeting schedule, want to stay near suitable cafés/co-working spaces, and need quick answers about basic administrative processes (e.g., business registration, tax office location) to report back to HQ.

-Ideal Journey

- + On arrival, the user opens the AI buddy on their laptop (web, no install) from the hotel Wi-Fi. They start with text chat in English: “I’ll be in Da Nang for 7 days for meetings. Which area should I stay in if I want quiet cafés to work and easy access to the city centre?”
- + The AI suggests a few neighbourhoods, with high-level descriptions (business-friendly, walkable, near offices) and links out to map locations.
- + Next, the user asks: “Tomorrow morning I need to visit the tax office and then a co-working space nearby. Can you give me directions and a Grab link?”
- + The AI returns:

- The correct office address in Vietnamese,
 - A clear description in English,
 - A **Grab deep-link** so they can book a ride without retyping the address.
- + Between meetings, the user asks: “What are the basic steps for a foreign company to open a representative office here?” The AI provides a concise **high-level checklist** and points to the relevant official websites/offices, framed clearly as informational (not legal advice).

-Benefit

The business visitor experiences Da Nang not just as a holiday spot but as an easy place to work and navigate bureaucracy at a basic level. This reduces cultural and practical friction for future investors and professionals, supporting Da Nang’s positioning as a regional financial and business hub.

3. Long-Stay / Aspiring Resident – Exploring Life in Da Nang

-Context

A remote worker from Europe has already visited Da Nang once as a tourist. Now they return for a month to test if they want to live there longer-term. They need to understand everyday life: areas to live, commute times, basic admin (temporary residence, visa extensions), and how convenient the city feels.

-Ideal Journey

- + User opens the AI buddy from their phone browser on day 1 in Da Nang.
- + Using voice in English, they say: “I’m staying near Hải Châu now. Which neighbourhoods should I explore if I want a quieter area with cafés, gyms and not too far from the beach?”

- + The AI suggests several neighbourhoods with short descriptions (vibe, typical residents, distance to beach/centre) and proposes a **day route**:
 - Morning: caf  s in area A,
 - Afternoon: walk/ride around area B,
 - Evening: dinner options in area C.
- + During the day, they ask: “How bad is the traffic if I commute from here to the city centre at 8:30 a.m.?” The AI provides an estimate and suggests better time windows.
- + Later in the week, they ask: “What basic administrative steps do I need if I want to stay here longer as a remote worker?” The AI returns a **high-level overview**: where to find information about visas, temporary residence, and which official channels to follow, with links to the relevant government sites.

-Benefit

The long-stay user gets a realistic, low-friction sense of what it’s like to live in Da Nang day to day—moving around, working, and dealing with basic admin. This makes Da Nang feel like a viable place to live and work, not just a holiday stop, and encourages more balanced, long-term engagement with different parts of the city.

4. Local Resident – Everyday Questions and City Services

-Context

A young local resident hears about the AI buddy from a city campaign and wants to use it for quick, everyday tasks: checking weather and road conditions before commuting, and clarifying simple administrative questions (e.g., where to renew a driver’s license or pay certain fees).

-Ideal Journey

- + The resident opens the AI buddy on their phone browser on the way to work.
- + They type: “Is there any heavy rain expected in the next 2 hours near Liên Chiêu? I’m going by motorbike.” The AI gives a short forecast and suggests the safest time window to depart.
- + Later, they ask: “Where do I go to renew my driver’s license, and what documents do I need?”. The AI responds with:
 - The correct office name and address in Vietnamese,
 - A simple checklist of required documents,
 - A **Grab deep-link** for that address if they want to book a ride.

-Benefit

Local residents experience the AI buddy as a simple, low-friction front door to both city information and daily logistics. This reinforces trust in smart-city services and shows that “smart city” is not just for tourists, but for citizens’ everyday life.

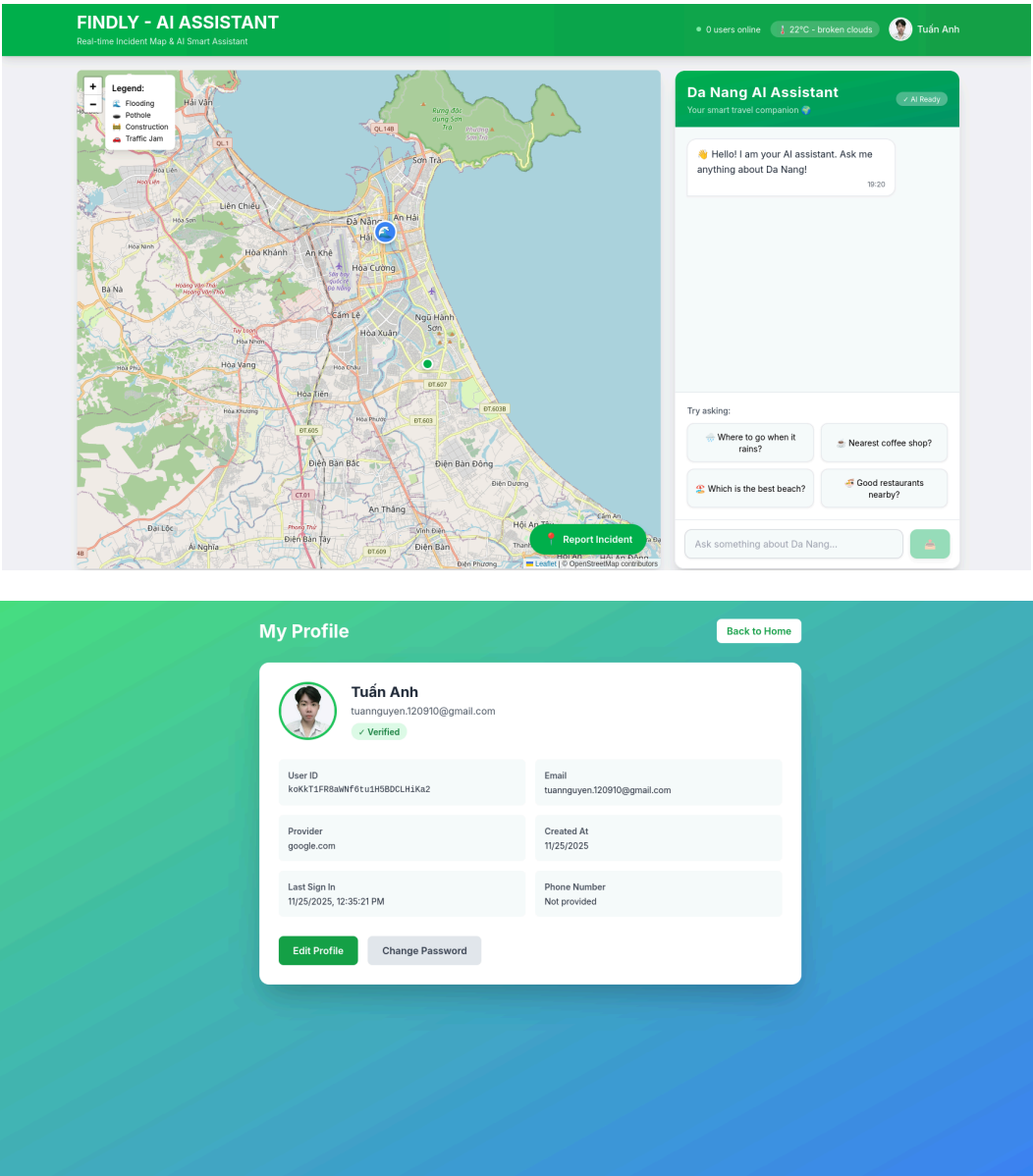
Mockups & Design (optional)

- Logo:



-Product interface:

+ Website



Solution Architecture

1. Technology Stack:

Component	Technology	Justification
Frontend	Next.js 14 (React, TypeScript) + Tailwind CSS + Leaflet + Socket.IO Client	Next.js provides a robust, scalable foundation with SSR/SSG. TypeScript ensures type safety. Leaflet is an efficient map library for map rendering, and Tailwind CSS enables rapid, responsive styling.
Backend	Node.js (Express) + Socket.IO	Node.js allows a unified language stack (JavaScript/TypeScript) across the application. Express provides a flexible REST API server. Socket.IO ensures real-time communication (WebSockets) essential for immediate hazard reporting updates.

Database	Firebase.	Firebase provides a fully managed, scalable NoSQL database (Firestore/Realtime Database) that is ideal for real-time updates (essential for hazard reporting). It integrates seamlessly with Cloud Storage for secure, scalable storage of media assets like user-submitted report photos, offering a unified, serverless backend environment.
Infrastructure	Vercel	Vercel provides seamless integration with Next.js, offering high-performance hosting, automatic Serverless Function scaling, and global CDN for low-latency delivery, which is critical for a fast user experience.
Monitoring		

2. High-Level Architecture

-The system is designed with a microservices-based architecture to ensure scalability, resilience, and independent deployment of core functionalities, primarily centered around the AI Recommendation Engine.

- + **Web Application (Frontend):** This is the user-facing Single Page Application (SPA) built using Next.js/React. It is responsible for user authentication, collecting natural language input, managing component state, displaying interactive map views (via Leaflet), showing real-time hazard overlays, and initiating deep-link calls to the Grab application via web redirection. It utilizes the **Socket.IO Client** for real-time updates and notifications pushed from the backend.
- + **API Gateway:** Acts as the single entry point for all client requests. Its core functions include JWT authentication for securing all services, rate limiting to prevent abuse, and load balancing/routing requests to the correct internal microservice (e.g., /recommendation, /reporting, /profile).
- + **Recommendation Service (AI Agent):** This is the heart of the application
 - **Flow:** It receives a natural language query, normalizes it, and sends it to the Gemini API for contextual interpretation and processing (with system context on Da Nang POIs).
 - **Data Retrieval:** It simultaneously queries the **POI Database** (PostgreSQL/Vector DB) to retrieve a set of highly relevant location candidates based on semantic similarity.
 - **Filtering & Ranking:** The service applies filters (e.g., operating hours, current user location, reported hazards) and uses a custom ranking algorithm (or a second small LLM call) to generate the final, personalized list of 3-5 locations.
- + **Reporting Service:** Manages the lifecycle of user-submitted road reports.
 - **Collection:** Accepts GeoPoint data, type (pothole/construction), and optional image uploads (stored in Supabase Storage).
 - **Validation:** Reports are initially marked new. In the short term, validation uses simple clustering or admin review. For the next phase, we will integrate a dedicated Visual Recognition Model (VRC) to automatically analyze the uploaded image and GPS data to classify the hazard type and veracity, changing the status to verified.

- **Real-Time Push:** Uses Socket.IO to instantly broadcast newly verified hazard locations to the Web App, ensuring all active users see real-time map updates without manual refresh.
- + **Third-Party Integration Services:** Dedicated functions handle external communications.
 - **Grab API Integrator:** Exclusively focuses on constructing the platform-agnostic deep-link URL based on the target destination's coordinates and name. This service ensures the URL format is current and adheres to Grab's specifications for smooth redirection.
 - **Google Maps Integrator:** Used by the Web App for base map tiles (via Leaflet), but this backend service is reserved for complex calculations, such as batch distance/time matrix lookups when generating a multi-stop itinerary or checking road conditions.

Implementation & Feature Breakdown

-This section focuses on the three most critical and complex features: AI Recommendation, Grab Integration, and the User Reporting System.

Key Feature / Component	Description	Technical Details (Simplified)
Feature 1: AI-Powered Recommendation	Allows the user to ask for travel suggestions using natural language (e.g., "I want a quiet coffee shop near My Khe Beach with a view"). The AI processes the query, filters POIs (Points of Interest) by location, mood, and time, and presents a ranked list.	- Input: User Query (Text). - Processing: Call to the custom Gemini API, utilizing detailed, custom system prompts to generate the recommendation text according to predefined rules (acting as a Da Nang expert agent) + retrieval of structured POI data from the Firebase Database (e.g., using vector embeddings for semantic similarity search). - Output: JSON list of 3-5 recommended locations displayed via React components.

Feature 2: Grab Deep Link Integration	Once a location is selected, a single button click generates a direct link that opens the Grab app or redirects to the booking page/app store, ensuring seamless transportation booking.	Client-Side Action: The web app constructs a URL (e.g., a universal deep link or a web URL for Grab's booking interface) using the selected location's coordinates and address. Fallback: The redirection logic includes error handling to inform the user if the deep link fails to open the application.
Feature 3: Real-Time Road Reporting	Allows users to submit reports on road hazards (potholes, construction) with a photo and location. These reports are shown to other users on the map to help them avoid problem areas instantly.	Data Model: Store reports in Firebase with fields: reporter_id, type (pothole/construction), status (new / verified /fixed), timestamp, location (GeoPoint), photo_url. Real-Time: The Reporting Service uses Socket.IO to push new verified hazard locations to all connected Web Apps, and Leaflet renders these as interactive markers.

Appendix